
UNIT 2: INTERPERSONAL SKILLS AND BODY LANGUAGE

Structure

- 2.0 Introduction
- 2.1 Learning Outcomes
- 2.2 Effective Communication
 - 2.2.1 Seven C's of Effective Communication
- 2.3 Communications skills
 - 2.3.1 Verbal Communication Skills
 - 2.3.2 Non-Verbal Communication Skills
- 2.4 Understanding Interpersonal Skills
 - 2.4.1 Importance of Interpersonal skills
- 2.4.2 Interpersonal skills for job search and at workplace
- 2.5 Types of Interpersonal skills
 - 2.5.1 Social Skills
 - 2.5.2 Peoples Skills
 - 2.5.3 Soft Skills
 - 2.5.4 Life Skills
- 2.6 Group Communication
- 2.7 Learning Essential Body Language
 - 2.7.1 Eye Contact
 - 2.7.2 Tone
 - 2.7.3 Space
 - 2.7.4 Handshake and Touch
 - 2.7.5 Facial Expression
 - 2.7.6 Hand Gestures
 - 2.7.7 Postures
- 2.8 Time Management
 - 2.8.1 Advantage of good Time Management.
 - 2.8.2 How to manage time?
- 2.9 Let Us Sum Up
- 2.10 Feedback to Check Your Progress Question
- 2.11 References and Further Reading

2.0 INTRODUCTION

In this competitive world the performance of an individual is measured not just on the basis of grades but also on the basis of certain other skills and aptitude. Interpersonal skills are one of the most important skills that a professional must have. According to the Oxford Dictionary the definition of interpersonal skills is “The ability to communicate or interact well with other people.” Interpersonal skills are required everywhere in family, social life or workplace. One of the most important stages of life where interpersonal skills are required most is when one faces an interview. The way one talks, behaves with others, dresses up, one's gestures, postures, listening skills etc all are part of interpersonal skills that one has to work on. These skills can be learned and with practice they can be mastered.

Mastering good interpersonal skills will help you in developing leadership qualities and good perform workplace by making your social interaction better. These interpersonal skills become important as they help one to showcase the technical knowledge attained, getting opportunities to showcase one's talent and standout amongst others.

In this unit we will learn and understand about various interpersonal skills and body language.

2.1 Learning Outcomes

An interpersonal skill is a subject that has to be practiced to achieve the desired goal. This unit is designed with relevant exercises at the end of each topic, which will help the learners to enhance their interpersonal skills.

After going through this unit and practicing the exercises your will be able to:

- Demonstrate good verbal and non verbal communication skills in different situations of life.
- Present yourself better according to the occasion and use body language to your advantage.
- Display excellent interpersonal and group communication skills.
- Manage Time effectively.

2.2 EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Human beings are social animals and communication is a very important part of human existence. Every individual communicates with the help of different languages and gestures. Effective communication helps one to present ones ideas, express one's thoughts, exchange the knowledge one has and helps in presenting the opinions in a convincing manner. This exchange of messages is done by the communicator (the person who communicates to others) with utter clarity and the purpose of communication is achieved effectively. Effective communication is the communication where what the sender (the one who wants to communicate the message) says is understood in the same way by the receiver (the one to whom the message is communicated). In another words there is no change in meaning of a message when it is communicated from the sender to the receiver. No scope of misunderstanding makes communication effective.

Communication has many forms, it could be Verbal communication (the one which include language and sounds), Written communication (the one that include text or different written languages), Non-verbal Communication (the one that include gestures etc) and lastly Visual Communication (Which includes, graphs, charts illustration etc). All these forms will be explained in details as we move ahead. It is very important to understand these forms and how to use these forms effectively for best results in communication.

EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION



Source: <https://digiaide.com/effective-communication/>

While meaning of communication and clarity in it is an important factor in communicating effectively, another important factor is the channel of communication that the sender is choosing to communicate. The message that the sender wants to communicate can be sent through emails, through phones (verbally or through applications like whatsapp, messenger etc), in person, through internet etc.

The medium of communication has its own importance in communication. The different media also have different formats for Example: When communicating through social media one should know the abbreviations that are generally used like LOL (Laugh Out Loud), ASAP (As Soon as possible), NB(Not Bad), MT (Modified Tweet) etc. This dictionary of abbreviations keeps on increasing and one has to keep oneself updated. Emojis are also a form of communication that one should know when and where to use. The Emoji or also known as emoticons are form of non-verbal visual communication forms. They are a form of pictogram, the smileys that are used a lot these days in present communication on the web. The emoticons add feelings without articulating in words in a web conversation. Use of wrong emojis can lead to trouble so the correct meaning and use should be learnt for effective communication through these emoticons.

Know what is the communication situation and context.

If you are appearing for a job interview, the objective of communication is different and when you are doing to explain a project to a client, the communication objective is different. The way communication is planned and executed will differ bases on these objectives.



Source: <https://blog.emojipedia.org/openemoji-a-free-and-open-source-emoji-set/>

One can learn effective communication by learning and practicing 7c's of communication that should be applied in any communication situation for positive results.

2.2.1 Seven C's of Effective Communications

It is very important to have a clear understanding of the real objective of you should communication. Once the goal of communication is set there are other principles of communication that will help you achieve your goal.

The seven C's of communications are as follows:

1. Clarity
2. Correctness
3. Conciseness
4. Courtesy
5. Concreteness
6. Consideration
7. Completeness

Let us understand these seven C's of communication in detail.

- 1) **Clarity:** Clarity play an important role in sucessful communication. The message designed to be delivered should be clear and should be easily understood by the receiver. Firstly what has to be communicated should be clear to the sender. Too much communication at a time could confuse the receiver, so it is best to keep the communication short and precise. The language should be kept simple and according to the target audience or the receiver for example, if the communication is designed for the higher management of an organization, then the language should be formal and technical language may also be used. But if something has to be communicated to general public, then it is adverisble to keep it simple.



- 2) **Correctness:** It is very important to have command over language and to design a correct communication message. Writing is an art that one achieves through constant practice. It is important that the message should have correct grammar, punctuations and also correct spelling. The accuracy of the message also presents a good image to the receiver. To practice correctness it is very important to re-check the content for grammatical errors and spelling mistakes. The level of difficulty of the language should also be kept according to the receiver and the sentences should be designed accordingly.
- 3) **Conciseness:** The communication message should be brief and crisp sentences should not be unnecessarily lengthy to facilitate understanding. The message should also convey the point directly. An effective communication is concise saves time and catches the attention of the receiver and is retained. The communicator should repetition in the message, use relevant information and avoid unnecessary expressions.
- 4) **Courtesy:** “Politeness costs nothing and gains everything.” The following quote is very important when it comes to communication with others. A communication becomes redundant if the experience of the receiver is not good. So courtesy becomes one of the most important factors in designing a communication message. The communication message design should be polite towards the sender. Uses of words like thank you, I appreciate, please etc makes a message full of courtesy and while verbally communicating the tone or the expression should sound genuine while communicating these words. It is very important to say whatever is written or communication message designed with full sincerity and for that one should use the tone that sounds respectful. It is also very important not to include discrimination in language for, racial, gender, color creed etc.

- 5) **Concreteness** The message should be specific and the point. Make your communication message meaningful as unclear and vague message results to distraction and the purpose of communication is lost in the process. You may also use facts and figures in your message. It is recommended to use active voice rather than passive voice.
- 6) **Consideration:** Always design the communication keeping the receiver in mind. It is very important to design the communication message from the point of view of receiver for whom it has to be designed. If the communicator is considerate than only he or she can develop the “you attitude” and design a sincere message keeping in mind the usefulness of the message. The “you” has to be considered instead the “we” and also keep in mind to be make the message positive and also optimistic in approach.
- 7) **Completeness:** Make sure whatever you want to communicate should be complete as incomplete message leaves the receiver confused and can also lead to a completely different meaning of the message as opposed to what was intended by the to source or communicator

Check your progress: 1

Note: Write your answer in the space given below:
Check your answer given at the end of the unit

Q.1 What are the four forms of communications of effective communication?

.....
.....
.....
.....

Q.2 What are the seven C's of communication?

.....
.....
.....
.....

2.3 Communication Skills

Professional life, social life and personal life all require good communication skills. It is important to communicate one's feelings and the ideas precisely and effectively. Good communication skills can help an individual in working effectively and progressing in professional life. effective communication leads to better understanding. Good communication skills at professional level may help you in explaining a project effectively to your clients and seniors. or in cracking a job interviews. Effective communication skills include holding fruitful conversation good listening skills, mindful observation and skills of emphasizing important points with the people you are interacting.

Communication skills will also teach one to interact effectively in different kinds of communication situation like one to one interaction, group communication, communication over phone, video calling, communication on internet (social media communication, emails etc) and so on.

Let us start by learning about verbal communication skills or spoken communication skills.

2.3.1 Verbal Communication Skills

Developing one's language skills is essential for enhancing interpersonal skills. Verbal communication can be expressed orally or in sign language. Language, grammar and articulation of language is important to learn. It is essential to support language with effective non-verbal skills like body language, facial expression and the voice modulation about which we will learn in this unit.

The following are some of the important aspects of verbal communication:

- An important aspect of verbal communication is how you greet the receiver and introduce yourself. It helps you from the first impression on the receiver of your communication which can be your interviewer, boss, colleges or any other common audience.
- It is also important to choose your words carefully. These combined with the non-verbal skills make for an effective communication.
- The communication situation also decides how words are presented for eg. a professional presentation calls for a formal language while an official dinner sees a mix of formal and informal words and expressions. If the written communication is for an official email even then the language will be formal but if it is about some festival celebration then the language will change accordingly.
- Active listening is also very important to develop good verbal skills. As in case of spoken communication until one listens to the receiver carefully, communication cannot become fruitful. So one should concentrate on what the other party has to say and not be rigid one's thoughts. One should be open to ideas and not be judgemental. One should allow the speaker to complete what they are saying and not interrupt in between. One should also try to avoid noise and other distractions and be objective. The same is applicable for written communication like taking notes in a meeting.
- Cultural factors are also important to consider as they can influence the receiver. So cultural factors should be kept in mind while drafting the message.
- During spoken communication, one should also keep in mind the tone, speed and volume of the communication. Tone makes a great deal of difference in communication, for example, if one says thank you in a sarcastic manner then the whole meaning of the communication changes. The speed at which one communicates is also important. You may have noticed that if someone speaks very slowly it gets boring and when someone speaks very fast, the concentration of the audience gets lost and the communication message is also lost. Communication volume is also important as these days people suffer from information overload, i.e. consuming huge amount of communication from multiple resources. That too makes communication ineffective.

Advantage of effective verbal communication

Effective verbal communication has many advantages through which one can develop one's interpersonal skill;

- ✓ It builds good relations
- ✓ It can help in persuading others
- ✓ It brings clarity and leaves no room for confusion
- ✓ Helps in improving productivity
- ✓ It helps in increasing motivation levels.

2.3.2 Non-Verbal Communication Skills

Communication also happens without the use of language whether spoken or written. The art of using eye contact, body language, gestures, facial expression, different postures etc. is non-verbal communication skills. Non verbal communication is important in several ways. Researches have shown that 35% of any communication comprises of verbal communication while 65% is non-verbal. This illustrates the importance of non-verbal communication. Non-verbal communication helps to develop effective interpersonal communication skills. Let us learn and understand these:

Silence is an important part of non-verbal communication. It is important to learn the art of silence and use it when required.

Five important roles of non –verbal communication skills

- Non verbal cues can be ***repeated*** and help in making verbal communication skills strong.
- The non-verbal cues add as ***substitutes*** to the spoken language as expressions are enough to communicate at times.
- Many a times non-verbal communication especially body language can ***compliment*** verbal communication and adds to the effectiveness of the communication. For example while saying thank you to someone if you fold your hands and smile it adds to the communication.
- Non verbal communication also helps in ***emphasizing*** upon what is being said. If someone is patted on the back while being appreciated it adds value to spoken words and the receiver feels that the appreciation is genuine.
- Body language never lies. If what you say is not what you mean, your body language may contradict your speech and the receiver may be doubtful of your words.

The types of body language will be discussed later in this Unit in detail. Let us first understand what are interpersonal skills.

Check your progress: 2

Note: Write your answer in the space given below:
Check your answer given at the end of the unit

Q.3 What are the advantages of effective verbal communication?

.....

.....

.....

.....

Q.4 What are the five important non-verbal Communication skills?

.....

.....

.....

.....

2.4 UNDERSTANDING INTERPERSONAL SKILLS

Interpersonal skills are all about developing the people's skill, the social skills, soft skills and life skill which are all helpful in different aspects of life. One requires good interpersonal skills to communicate with everyone on daily basis. Some people naturally inherit good interpersonal skills, but these skills can be learned by anyone who wants to be a good communicator and wants to develop good relationship with those they communicate. To achieve these interpersonal skills it is important to practice them on daily basis in both personnel and professional space.

Employees in an organization who showcase good interpersonal skills are noticed, get good opportunities and are also promoted faster as they are able to present their work better than other and prove themselves as asset to the company. Interpersonal skills when used according to the situation, people and culture along with appropriate tactics, can lead to effective communications. Good interpersonal skills combined with technical skills is the key for a successful career.



Interpersonal skills are very important and are used in different situations of life. It is important for team building, developing communication skills, and for conflict management; it also helps in developing persuasion skills, affirmation skills, adaptability in any situation i.e. people and culture, as well as negotiation skills too. Let us discuss the importance of interpersonal skills in detail.

2.4.1 Importance of Interpersonal skills

Interpersonal skills are useful in everyday conversations and in many aspects of life. Let us understand them one by one.

- Good interpersonal skills increase the chances of success of your communication no matter whether its verbal (spoken or written skills) or non verbal (body moments, postures, eye contact etc).
- Interpersonal skills also teach the art of active listening i.e. not just listening to the words but also processing it in your mind and retaining what you deem important. Then the receiver gives feedback to the sender thus making the communication process two way.
- Good Interpersonal skill helps in building good relationship with people and develop positive attitude.

2.4.2 Interpersonal skills for job search and at workplace

It is important to understand, learn and practice interpersonal skills as it may help at the time of job interview and for getting a job and then to excel at workplace. Let us see how;

Interpersonal skills for Jobs search

A job interview is not just a test of the knowledge or technical knowhow but also a test of interpersonal skills required for the profile. Here are some pointers that will help you develop these for a job interview:

- Be a Good Listener, listen carefully what interviewer is asking
- Job openings in the field of law, marketing and sales etc require negotiation skills, remember not to be aggressive while displaying them.
- Verbal and non-verbal skills are being tested speak confidently and know that both are tested here.
- Most of the positions require you to work in team, so you will also be tested on your team skills. For eg. the interviewer may give you situations and ask what you would do when confronting such a situation? At that time remember what it takes to be a good team leader and work effectively in team. The idea is to test if you can be a team player and whether you could be a team leader.
- You could also be given situations or asked questions to understand your conflict management skills. The interviewer is looking for the best conflict management tactics to be implemented according to the situation.
- Also collaborations is also one area where you will be tested.

Interpersonal skills at workplace

Interpersonal skills are very helpful when it comes to workplace. It is important to be knowledgeable and technically sound but it is of no use if you will not be able to share that knowledge effectively. Let us understand what all interpersonal skills are important at workplace:

- An important aspect of interpersonal skill set is negotiations skills. As you progress in your career these skills come handy. They benefit both the employees and organization.
- Problem solving skills are also important. This skill set increases productivity at workplace.
- Team work comes next in the list. Primarily teamwork builds a positive environment which gets quality work.
- Being skilled in making presentations, emails, projects proposals etc. enhances verbal communication skills whether spoken or written.
- Appropriate eye contact, gestures and facial expressions etc also aid in communicating effectively through interpersonal skills.
- These skills also enhance dependability, empathy and responsibility of employees in a workspace.

Such skills help in promoting positive attitude, confidence, enthusiasm and help in building a good rapport amongst employees. That is the reason why companies attach much value and importance to training pertaining to interpersonal skills regularly.

Activity 1

List down five interpersonal skills that you think are essential for your personality. Also Write down why it is important for you to learn these skills.

[illegible]

2.5 TYPES OF INTERPERSONAL SKILLS

We may consider four broad categories of interpersonal skills social skills, people's skills, soft skills and life skills. Let us understand each one of them in detail.

2.5.1 Social Skills

Man is a social animal and socialization is important for excelling in life. Social skills are learnt in childhood. Infact, learning begins with social skills. Any where you go including both personnel life and professional life you will encounter we come across different types of people, everyone you interact with may not be the same all the time and every individual has to be dealt with differently. It is the art of socialization that helps us do so.

Below are some imports tips that you can use to develop good social skills and relationships with people:

- Always remember every individual is not the same. Some people talk a lot, some are introvert and don't talk much but are good listeners, some people take a lot of time to open up and develop trust. while you interact with anyone try not to judge the person. Instead understand him as it her will help you in socializing better.
- Be emphatic towards others and try to think from their point of view. It will help you develop better understanding of the person which eventually leads to developing good relationship.
- A stubborn attitude is never welcome. Always corporate with people whether at home or workplace. People who corporate are liked in turn will get cooperation from others when they require it.
- Respect is very important in any social relationship. People who give respect also get it in personal and professional lives.
- It is also important to maintain appropriate distance with people you work with. If people don't feel comfortable around you it becomes difficult to communicate and maintain good social relationship. Especially in case of opposite genders it is important to maintain a healthy physical distance. Bad breath, body odor is another factor that could upset other so make sure you do not smell bad before you go near people.
- People who are of complaining nature are not liked. So develop a positive attitude, be thankful, and try to stay happy at home and workplace.

2.5.2 Peoples Skills

People's skills focus more on the interaction that one has with others. Developing people's skills is more about understanding the behaviour of the people you are interacting with. Individuals have behavioral patterns which could be understood with time. Understanding this pattern can help one to figure out how to deal with people with different behaviors. People skills helps in better interaction, managing difficult people, and building trust.

Learning people's skills lets you to develop an effective personality, develop interaction and negotiation skills. Do you know how people at work perceive you? Do

they find your personality pleasing? Do they find you easy or difficult to interact? Do people like to work with you. If not, why not? These entire questions along with others are important to develop your personality. Self analysis is best, you may also take advice of your good friends.

Peoples skills also emphasizes on how to communicate effectively by being respectful and empathetic. It teaches that building rapport with your target audience is must for effective communication to happen as it builds trust.

2.5.3 Soft Skills

Other than learning soft skills, how well you develop and use them also depends on one's emotional intelligence. Especially in professions where one has to look after customer service or deal with clients in a company these soft skills help a person to build good relationship even without any specific training.

Some of the soft skills that are appreciated and valued by any companies are:

Creativity: every job whether it is working for a factory, corporate office, working on site with different institutions all of them require creativity. It is known to bring innovations and adds new solutions to the problem.

Use of humor: Humor makes any environment light. A person with good sense of humor displays a strong personality as it helps in building good relations trust and reduces stress.

Confidence: A person with self-confidence will take initiatives and will be better with making decisions. Self-confidence is also important to work under pressure. It also boosts other soft skills learned.

Honesty: An honest person is trusted more and earns dignity that makes one valuable for any organization.

Friendliness: Friendly people are sociable, persuasive and he can be good stress busters. But at workplace, it is also important to maintain professional environment.

Common sense: Common sense, they say is quite uncommon. But its presence in an individual take faster decisions is the sense that everyone should know yet many people lack it.

These soft skills add to any personality and makes the person valuable for his/her co-workers, seminars, and the organization as a whole.

2.5.4 Life Skills

The psychosocial competencies along with interpersonal skills that helps one to develop problem solving skills, critical thinking skills, creative thinking and decision making skills are counted under life skills. Life skills are important for a productive and healthy living.

Stress Management is an essential part of life skills as in professional environment where quality work needs to be delivered within the deadline. You will be learning about how to manage stress in other units to follow.

Emotional regulation is also important to learn. Every individual has to deal with personal and emotional life together. At times one might be dealing with crisis at personal or professional front and it might lower one's productivity. It becomes important to regulate one's emotions. Meditation, various exercises and certain tactics help one to regulate the emotional crisis that one may be going through.

Self-awareness: The first step is to understand what you are feeling and why are you feeling a certain way.

Mindfulness: Mindfulness includes being aware of your surrounding what is happening around you and in your body. There are many activities you can search to practice mindfulness. It will help you calm yourself and concentrate on the present.

Cognitive reappraisal: It is a part of psychotherapy and anger management. Through cognitive reappraisal one can alter the way he or she thinks. If at workplace you don't like a person to work with this can help you change the way you think about it and respond to the person.

Adaptability: It teaches one how to do objective evaluation of one's situation. For eg. you may ask yourself questions like why you are feeling a certain way or how is the situation affecting your work, what is important at the moment etc. This will help you think objectively make you mindful and enhance productivity.

Self-compassion: Be kind to yourself and practice self-care. It increases your self-worth. Remind yourself your qualities and write them in a piece of paper. Take out time for yourself, meditate or do some yoga. Do some breathing exercise it will help you relax. It is also recommended to keep a gratitude journal.

Emotional support: One can have support group in form of friends and family, counselors at workplace or other support groups. The best support you could find is within yourself, so seek help with yourself by self-awareness and mindfulness and if it does not help, one should not hesitate to seek help outside.

These are some skills that could be learnt to regulate emotions and are very beneficial. It helps one to regulate feeling and not let them affect the reactions. These life skills also help one to think objectively and to display a regulated behaviour with self-control.

2.6 GROUP COMMUNICATION

Communication with more than one person at a time is called group communication. The members of group may be acquainted to you or they can be strangers. The size of the group also varies. Communication has to be designed depending on these factors. These skills come handy while giving presentations to internal, external clients and during exchanging of ideas and trainings.

Different channels used for group communication

Face-to-face group meetings: One of the most effective ways of communicating a message to more than one person is by calling a meeting. As a communicator if you want to make people understand some work, project, task etc. a meeting could be called and the message could be explained personally. The advantage of this method is that feedback is instant from the receiver and hence doubts and confusions can be cleared making the communication process fruitful.

Conference calls/video calls: If the team you are working with is not at same place then use of technology comes handy. Many organizations have their own video or conference calling system as part of the companies' data security policies. In the post pandemic times they have become a part of the most people's work lives. Video calls are effective as they include both verbal and non-verbal communication.

Emails/Digital Messages: One of the fastest ways of communicating a message to multiple recipients is through emails. For email your written communication skills should be good. Other social media apps may also be used for digital communication.

Notice/Memos: Notices and memos are a part of written group communication in an set up. Notice could be used for open communication and memos for confidential communication.

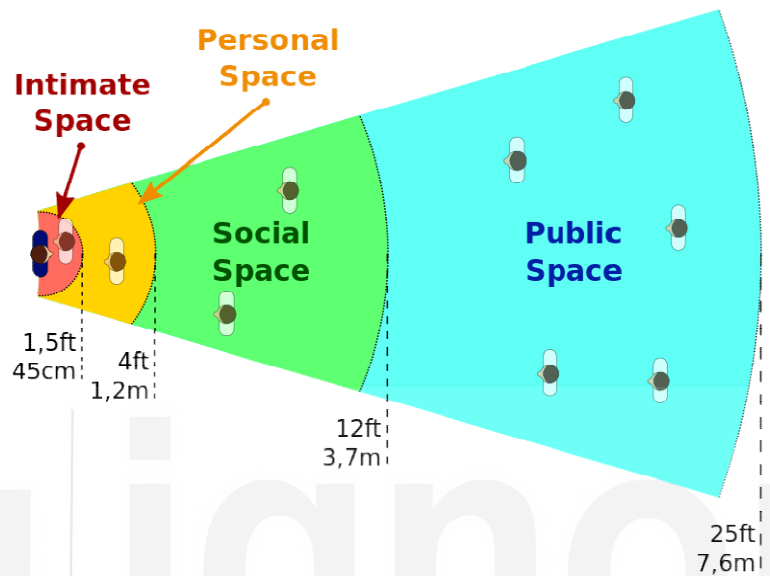
2.7 LEARNING ESSENTIAL BODY LANGUAGE

Body Language: The use of gestures, postures and body expressions accompanying verbal communication constitute body language. The eye contact one makes while talking and one's tone of voice is also a part of body language. The body language you use draws attention of people towards you, and helps your audience form an impression of you. For eg. if you look straight into the eyes of the person you are addressing or your audience, you are able to win the trust of the receiver. If during a conversation you fold your arms across your chest, it is a sign to the other person that you are not open to his/her idea. Specially with palms open is a sign of honesty.

Different aspects of body language are explained below:

- 2.7.1 Eye Contact:** When the communicator makes eyes contact with the receiver it shows confidence and helps in holding the attention of the communicator. The way you look at the receiver or the audience and for how long you look is also important. Eye contact reflects genuineness of the speakers. Besides this, eye contact also helps the speaker to figure out if the receivers is understanding and is interested in what is being said.
- 2.7.2 Tone:** The tone in which something is said is important. In any conversation its not just the words that are important but the way they are being said is equally important the style, the tone of voice, whether the communicator is empathetic or aggressive? All these things are noticed.
- 2.7.3 Space:** The physical distance between you and the person you are having a conversation with is also important to consider. Standing too close to someone can be intimidating and uncomfortable for the person you are speaking with. Always respect the personal physical space, especially if the conversation is a

formal or between people of opposite gender. This physical distance at which we speak depends upon the culture, your relationship with the person and the situation. The physical distance between two people may be less if they enjoy a close relationship with each others. The diagram below indicates the physical distance between individuals in different situations and according to proximity.



Source

https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Personal_Spaces_in_Proxemics.svg

2.7.4 Handshake and Touch: Handshake is a very important part of creating your first impression. It is important to learn the right way to shake hand as it is a frequently used gesture in professional settings.



Source: <https://pxhere.com/en/photo/1436889>

While shaking hand keep the following points in mind

- Shake hand with right hand, even if you are left handed it is not essential that person opposite is also lefty, so always shake hand with left hand. If you have some object like your phone or a briefcase make sure to hold it in left hand before you shake hand.
- Don't squeeze the hand of the person you are shaking hands with, nether make hand limp to make it a dead fish hand shake. The pressure applied should be appropriate and brief. Shake hands firmly as it leaves a good impression and the person seems confidant.

- In interview situations don't hold the hand for too long nor just leave it in a second. One can shake hands for longer with people who are well acquainted to you.
- It is recommend to greet by saying hello, welcome and to start the conversation before you let go of the hand.

2.7.5 Facial Expression: There are seven expressions called 'navrasas' that include the expressions of happiness, anger, fear, sadness, disgust, astonishment and surprise. These are common for most of the cultures yet one should be careful as some societies are very expressive and others are not. Expressions should be used depending on the nature of communication. Don't be too dramatic with your expression as it may upset your audience. Use genuine expressions and in a controlled manner depending upon the situation you are in. Always think before you communicate. Expressions are different when one communicates personally as compared to professionally or with on individual or a group or large audience.

2.7.6 Hand Gestures: We use gestures all the time consciously or subconsciously. Humans often communicate with hand movements, we use different sign hand gestures to call someone, to communicate stop, to say no or to say Ok. Different societies and cultures use different gestures to communicate the same. It is very important to know the culture and society where you are going to communicate and to learn their language of gestures in order to use it correctly as gestural language used in one culture can be offensive in others.

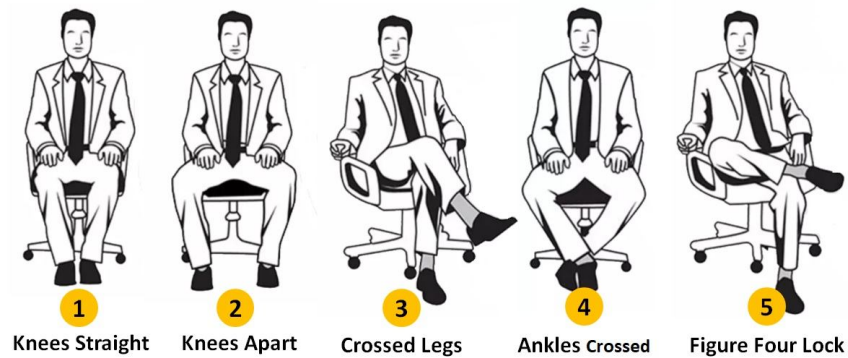


Source: <https://www.publicdomainpictures.net/en/view-image.php?image=46180&picture=fingers-gesture>

2.7.7 Posture: The way a person sits, stand, walk, and position their head, shakes hands also communicate a lot. There is a proper way to do all these things and it important to learn theses skills as it communicating well helps in creating positive impressions.

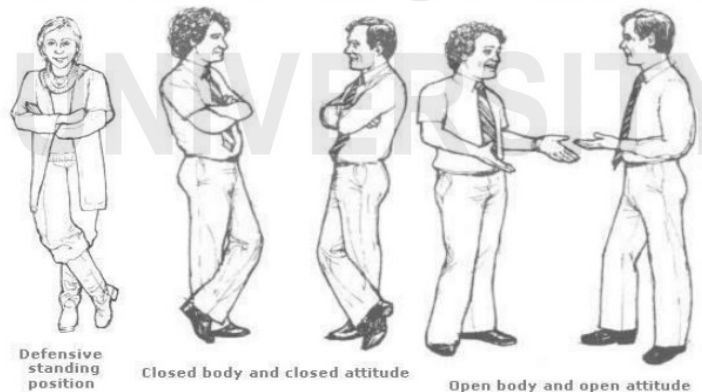
2.7.7.1 Sitting positions differs for males and females i.e. men sitting with legs apart may appear confident or relaxed whereas men sitting with their legs together may be seen as not so confident or worried, this may also be read as the mark of man not ready to open-up. Women are generally seen sitting cross legged, it is a feminine position which is though closed

but also elegant and refined. Sitting in Figure four lock (show below) comes across as dominating, but also confident.



Source: <https://www.jagranjosh.com/general-knowledge/personality-test-your-sitting-positions-reveals-these-personality-traits-1655726286-1>

2.7.7.2 Standing positions: The way one stands also supplements your speech. The figure below shows various standing positions (unless it is very cold). Cross legged and cross hands are also a defensive position and convey that the communicator is trying to hide something and is not very open to the speaker's ideas. Standing with equal weight on both legs and open hands shows a positive personality who is open to new thoughts and ideas during the conversation.



Source: <https://mcburgess11.wordpress.com/tag/body-language/page/2/>

Activity 2

Ask your friend/family member to make a video while you are talking in any communication situation. Fill in the following table to analyze the body Language that you are using correctly while communicating with others and what improvement it requires.

Body Language used Currently	Improvements it require

2.8 Time Management

Time management is a skill that helps in achieving more in less time. All famous and successful people have learned new skills and knowledge with the help of effective time management skills. Before we can learn time management lets understand what time management is. Time management is the process of planning and dividing time according to what one desire to achieve. Time management helps in organizing your goals with an effective plan; it is an activity of dividing your time smartly so that you don't end up wasting your time in working hard unproductively.

2.8.1 Advantage of good time management

Effective time management has many advantages which include:

- One can achieve **greater productivity** through better management of time as planning can help in managing time in a manner that more work can be done in a better way and in less time.
- It helps in achieving **efficiency** through time table which helps in avoiding boredom and also helps one in generating the flow of work.
- Better time management leads to productivity and efficiency which leads to sense of achievement. This **reduces stress** levels in a person.
- It helps in **increasing focus** on the task/goals as it helps in planning one thing at a time but also it helps in achieving set goals.
- Helps in better **decision making** as planning always leads a person to think how and when , a work is done which helps in saving time, leads to better productivity and makes one take the right decisions.
- One can reach his or her set **goal faster** with effective time management.
- Time management skills helps in improving the **quality of work** as it every task or goal is thought through before it is done which eventually leads to good output.
- One acquires more confidence as it leads positive **self-enforcement**. The plan is created and executed by oneself and once the results start showing

the motivation of the person increases and the process also become self-driven.

- Time management helps in developing *self-discipline* as one need to follow the plan and monitor oneself to achieve it.
- It helps you create a good image at workplace.

2.8.2 How to manage time?

You must be considered by now that it is important to manage time well for achieving goals and it is also important to learn interpersonal skills. Now let us see how to manage time. Study the following steps:

Step 1 Set your Goals

The first task is to prioritize your goals. Ask yourself what are your goals? What are the interpersonal skills you want to develop in your personality? Effective time managers follow SMART Goals. Let us understand this. One should ask the following before setting any goals:

Specific: Set clear and specific goals.

Measurable: The Goals that you set should be measurable so that you can know how much you have achieved.

Achievable: choose goals that are achievable. If you feel they are difficult to achieve break them down in steps. Make them attainable.

Relevant: The goals that you are setting should be relevant to you and your organization and should be result based.

Time Bound: The most important thing is to give timelines to your goal. Time bound goals with discipline become realistic to achieve.

Step 2 Prioritization

It is very important to prioritize your goals. You may have multiple goal to achieve but it is important to decide, which one is most important. The goals that are most important should be given more time, so that they maybe achieved at the earliest. You can make a chart in which you can write your goal in the order of their priority and can write the time you want to give to each goal along with priority.

Step 3 Scheduling

Scheduling your goals is also very important. Usually morning times are very effective to work as energy levels are high and its easier to concentrate. But some people are comfortable working late hours. So it is recommended to find your peak time of work, when you are most productive and schedule your high priority goals at that time.

Step 4 Concentrate and focus

Prioritising and scheduling are easier tasks than following the plan of action. At such a time, staying focused and concentrated on your goal is important. There are times when

one may not be to follow through. It is important to motivate yourself by looking at what has been achieved. This generates enthusiasm and positivity.

Step 5 Follow your deadlines

Deadlines help in setting realistic expectations and ensure that the work is delivered on time. One should stay disciplined and follow one's deadlines.

Step 6 Practice time management

It is easy to make a time management plan but sometimes it becomes difficult to steadily follow it. Practice makes it a habit.

Activity 3

Fill in the following table to analyze your current time management skills and the changes you would like to introduce after reading this module

Current time management plan	The plan developed after going through time management skills

2.9 LET US SUM UP

In this unit we learned how to communicate effectively communication. Various types of communication i.e. visual communication, verbal communication, non-verbal communication and written communication were discussed in detail. Also the 7c's of effective communication i.e. clarity, correctness, conciseness, courtesy, concreteness, consideration and completeness and how they make communication effective were also discussed.

We also learned the importance of interpersonal communication skills. Various interpersonal communication skills like social skills, soft skills, people's skills and life skills were explained. The importance of interpersonal skills at professional front and at the time of facing an interview was also discussed at length.

A board overview of aspects of body language like eye contact, tone, space, handshake and touch, facial expressions, hand gestures and postures were also given to explain how body language can help a great deal in attaining good interpersonal skills.

In the end, we time management and its advantages and how to manage time effectively.

2.10 FEEDBACK TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS QUESTION

Check your progress 1

Answer 1: The four form of communication used for effective communication are

- 1) Verbal communication
- 2) Written Communication
- 3) Non-verbal Communication
- 4) Visual Communication

Answer 2: The seven C's of communications are as follows:

1. Clarity
2. Correctness
3. Conciseness
4. Courtesy
5. Concreteness
6. Consideration
7. Completeness

Check your progress 2

Answer 3: An affective verbal communication has many advantages through which a person can develop his or her interpersonal skill;

- It builds good relations
- Important for persuading others
- It brings clarity and leaves no room for confusion
- Helps in improving productivity
- Also lead to increase of motivation levels.

Answer 4: Five important roles of non –verbal communication skills

- Non verbal cues can be repeated and it helps in making the verbal communication skills strong.
- The non-verbal cues add as substitutes to the spoken communication as expression are enough at times to communicate what one wants to communicate.
- Many times non-verbal communication especially body language can compliments the verbal communication and adds to the effectiveness of the communication. For example while saying thank you to someone if you fold your hands and smile it adds to the whole communication message being communicated.
- Non verbal communication also helps in emphasizing the verbal communication message. If someone is patted on the back while being appreciated it accent the whole message.
- Sometime the message communicated with non verbal communication can also contradict the whole communication process if not done truthfully.

2.11 REFERENCES AND FURTHER READING

1. Agochiya, Davendra (2018). Life Competencies for Growth and Success A Trainer's Manual. Sage publications. p. 142. ISBN 978-9352805280.
2. Berger, Charles R. (2005-09-01). "Interpersonal communication: Theoretical perspectives, future prospects". Journal of Communication. 55 (3): 415–447. doi:10.1111/j.1460-2466.2005.tb02680.x. ISSN 1460-2466.
3. Corbin, C. White, D. (2008). "Interpersonal Communication: A Cultural Approach." Sydney, NS. Cape Breton University Press
4. Forster, Mark (2006-07-20). Do It Tomorrow and Other Secrets of Time Management. Hodder & Stoughton Religious. ISBN 0-340-90912-9.

5. Isa N. Engleberg; Dianna R. Wynn; Maria Roberts (17 February 2014). THINK Interpersonal Communication, First Canadian Edition. Pearson Education. ISBN 978-0-205-99284-3.
6. Pease, Allan & Barbara (2004). The Definitive Book of Body Language. Orion House, London: Orion Books Ltd. p. 230. ISBN 978-0752861180.
7. Richard Walsh (2008). Time Management: Proven Techniques for Making Every Minute Count. Adams Media. ISBN 978-1-4405-0113-5.
8. "Understanding and Enhancing Interpersonal Communication". Explore Our Extensive Counselling Article Library. 2016-06-07. Retrieved 2022-07-10.



ignou
THE PEOPLE'S
UNIVERSITY